Preetam Dammu

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Information Science 2022 - Present
University of Washington, Seattle, Washington
- Advisor: Prof. Chirag Shah
- Dissertation Area: IR, NLP, CV, GenAI, Agents

Master of Technology, Artificial Intelligence 2017 - 2019
University of Hyderabad, Hyderabad, India
- Advisor: Prof. Raju S. Bapi
- Dissertation Area: StatML, NLP, CV

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

AWS AI June 2025 – Sep 2025
Applied Scientist II Intern
- Intern in AWS Themis team.
- Projects focused on Dynamic Evaluations of Agentic Systems.

Amazon Science June 2024 – Sep 2024
Applied Scientist II Intern
- Intern in Search Experience Science team.
- Projects focused on Generative Agents.

Amazon Science June 2023 – Sep 2023
Applied Scientist II Intern
- Intern in AlexaShopping / Nile Research team.
- Projects focused on LLMs and Evidence Attribution in NLG.

UW iSchool Sep 2022 - Present
Graduate Research Assistant
- Member of RAISE and InfoSeeking Lab.
- Research focused on Generative AI (Agents, VLMs & LLMs).

TCS Research Labs Aug 2019 – Sep 2022
Researcher
- Member of the "Secure and Private AI" research team
- Projects focused on solving security-related technological barriers to AI adoption.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Generative AI: Agents, VLMs & LLMs
- Responsible AI: Explainability, Fairness, Robustness, Security & Privacy
- Information Retrieval, Natural Language Processing
- Computer Vision

AWARDS

1) Azure Cloud Computing Credits (Co-PI, Amount: $20,000)
2) UW Top Scholar Award (Amount: 1 Quarter Funding & $5,000)
3) Gold Medal – SCIS, University of Hyderabad

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

1) **Dammu** et al. “iAgentBench: Benchmarking Sensemaking Capabilities of Information-Seeking Agents on High-Traffic Topics.” arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.04656. Paper Link. Webpage.
2) Theologitis, M., **Dammu, P.,** Shah, C., & Suciu, D. (2026). “ClaimDB: A Fact Verification Benchmark over Large Structured Data. arXiv preprint arXiv:2601.14698.” Paper Link. Webpage.
3) **Dammu** et al. “Dynamic-KGQA: A scalable framework for generating adaptive question answering datasets”. 48th ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval ***(SIGIR 2025).*** Paper Link. Webpage.
4) **Dammu**, et al. “A Shopping Agent for Addressing Subjective Product *Needs”. Proceedings of the 18th ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining* ***(WSDM 2025)***. Paper Link.
5) **Dammu** et al. "They are uncultured": Unveiling Covert Harms and Social Threats in LLM Generated Conversations*. Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing* ***(EMNLP 2024)***. Paper Link.
6) **Dammu** et al. ClaimVer: Explainable Claim-Level Verification and Evidence Attribution of Text Through Knowledge Graphs. *Findings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing* ***(EMNLP Findings 2024)***. Paper Link.
7) **Dammu** and Alonso. "Near-duplicate Question Detection". *Companion Proceedings of the ACM on Web Conference* ***(WebConf 2024)***. Paper Link.
8) Alonso, **Dammu**, & Yang. An Interpretable Answer Scoring Framework. *The Second Workshop on Generative Information Retrieval* ***(SIGIR Workshop 2024).*** Paper Link.
9) **Dammu** and Shah. "Detecting Spurious Correlations via Robust Visual Concepts in Real and AI-Generated Image Classification". *37th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems* ***(NeurIPS 2023), XAIA Workshop***. Paper Link.
10) **Dammu**, Feng, and Shah. "Addressing Weak Decision Boundaries in Image Classification by Leveraging Web Search and Generative Models". *Proceedings of the Thirty-Second International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence* ***(IJCAI 2023)***. Paper Link.
11) **Dammu** et al. "Explainable and Personalised Privacy Prediction". In *International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management Workshops* ***(CIKM Workshop 2021)***. Paper Link.
12) **Dammu** et al. "Interpretable and Robust Face Verification". In *International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management Workshops* ***(CIKM Workshop 2021)***. Paper Link.
13) **Dammu** & Bapi. "Employing Temporal Properties of Brain Activity for Classifying Autism Using Machine Learning". In *8th International Conference on Pattern Recognition and Machine Intelligence* ***(PReMI 2019)***. Paper Link.
14) **Dammu** & Bapi. "Temporal Dynamics of the Brain Using Variational Bayes Hidden Markov Models: Application in Autism". In *8th International Conference on Pattern Recognition and Machine Intelligence* ***(PReMI 2019)***. Paper Link.

PATENTS

1) Method and System for Feature Based Image Retrieval
   Inventors: **Dammu, P. P. S.**, Chalamala. S. R., & Singh, A.K.
   Application Numbers – US PTO: 17/660,034
2) Systems and Methods for Constructing a Modular Siamese Network for Face Verification
   Inventors: **Dammu, P. P. S.**, Chalamala. S. R., & Singh, A.K.
   Application Numbers – US PTO: 17/358,496
3) System and Method for Explainable and Personalised Privacy Prediction
   Inventors: **Dammu, P. P. S.**, Chalamala. S. R., & Singh, A.K.
   Application Numbers – US PTO: TBD